

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Number Portability Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Overview

This policy establishes the procedures, requirements, and timelines for customers seeking to port their existing telephone number from another carrier to Aether Wireless. Number portability allows subscribers to retain their telephone number when changing service providers, ensuring continuity of service and customer satisfaction. All retail staff and customer care representatives must follow these guidelines to process port requests accurately and efficiently. This policy applies to consumer and business customers porting US-based phone numbers to Aether Wireless.

Eligibility Requirements

A number is eligible for porting to Aether Wireless only when all of the following conditions are met:

- **Active Status:** The number must be currently active on the losing carrier's network. Disconnected or cancelled numbers cannot be ported.
- **Good Standing:** The account with the losing carrier must be in good standing with no outstanding balances, unpaid final bills, or unresolved billing disputes.
- **TPIN Verification:** The customer must provide a valid Transfer PIN (TPIN) or account PIN from the losing carrier. This PIN is required to authorize the port.
- **Account Number:** The customer must provide their current account number with the losing carrier.
- **Not Mid-Port:** The number must not currently be in the process of being transferred to another carrier. A number already in transit cannot be interrupted or reversed.
- **Not Suspended:** The number must not be suspended, frozen, or flagged for fraud investigation on the losing carrier's network.

Numbers that do not meet all eligibility criteria must be corrected or resolved before the port request can proceed.

Required Information

The following information must be collected and verified before submitting a port request. Inaccurate or incomplete information will result in port delays or rejection.

Field	Description	Notes
Telephone Number	The full 10-digit phone number to be ported	Include area code
Losing Carrier Account Number	Account number as it appears on the losing carrier's billing statement	Must match exactly
Transfer PIN (TPIN)	4-6 digit PIN provided by the losing carrier	Required for authorization
Account Holder Name	Legal name on the account with the losing carrier	Must match exactly
Service Address	Billing or service address on the losing carrier's account	Must match exactly
Account Type	Consumer, Business, or Prepaid	Affects port timeline

Porting Timelines

The time required to complete a number port varies based on the port type and geographic scope. All timelines represent business hours unless otherwise specified.

Standard Port Types

Port Type	Estimated Timeline	Notes
Same Region (Local)	2-4 hours	Number is within the same LATA and rate center
Cross-Region	24-48 hours	Number spans different LATAs or regions
Corporate/Business	3-5 business days	Requires additional verification and provisioning
Prepaid to Postpaid	24-48 hours	Transition from prepaid to Aether Wireless postpaid plan

Important Restrictions

- **US Numbers Only:** Aether Wireless processes port requests for US phone numbers (NPA-NXX within US territory) only. International numbers cannot be ported to Aether Wireless at this time.
- **Business Days:** Corporate port timelines are measured in business days (Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays).
- **Port Window:** Ports submitted after 3:00 PM local time may be processed the following business day.

Common Failure Reasons and Resolution

The following table identifies frequent reasons for port failures and the corresponding resolution steps.

Failure Reason	Resolution
Incorrect or Invalid TPIN	Request a fresh TPIN from the losing carrier; verify the customer has the current PIN
Name or Address Mismatch	Confirm exact spelling of name and address with losing carrier; update customer information if necessary
Suspended Line on Losing Carrier	Customer must resolve suspension with losing carrier before port can proceed
Pending Device Balance or ETF	Customer must pay any outstanding device financing balance or early termination fee to the losing carrier
Number Already in Transit	Wait for current port to complete (up to 48 hours) or cancel the pending port through the losing carrier
Losing Carrier Blocking Port	Contact the losing carrier to identify the block; may require customer to request release or file a complaint
Account Number Mismatch	Verify the account number matches the losing carrier's records exactly; check for hyphenation or prefix differences

Port Process

Follow these steps in sequence to process a number port request:

1. **Verify Eligibility:** Confirm the number is active, in good standing, not suspended, and not currently mid-port.
2. **Collect Information:** Gather all required information listed in the Required Information table. Verify each field for accuracy.
3. **Validate Identity:** Confirm the customer's identity by matching government-issued ID to the account holder name provided.
4. **Submit Port Request:** Enter all port information into the Carrier Services Portal. Double-check all fields before submission.
5. **Confirm Receipt:** The system will generate a port confirmation number. Provide this to the customer for their records.
6. **Monitor Status:** Check the port status in the portal every 2-4 hours for same-region ports, or at least once daily for longer timelines.
7. **Notify Customer:** Once the port completes successfully, contact the customer to confirm service activation.
8. **Document Resolution:** If the port fails, document the failure reason and initiate resolution steps immediately.

Escalation Procedures

Zero-Day Trouble Escalation

When a port request experiences issues or failures on the same day it was submitted, retail staff must escalate immediately to the Port Desk.

Escalation Criteria:

- Port rejected or failed on the same business day
- Customer reports no service after the stated timeline has elapsed

- Losing carrier is unresponsive or delaying the port
- Port confirmation not received within expected timeframe

Escalation Process:

1. Document the issue in the trouble ticket system with port confirmation number and all relevant details.
2. Contact the Port Desk via the internal escalation hotline or designated queue.
3. Provide the customer's phone number, losing carrier information, TPIN, and detailed description of the issue.
4. The Port Desk will engage the losing carrier's porting department and escalate within the carrier-to-carrier relationships.

Resolution Commitment: The Port Desk is committed to resolving escalated port issues within 24 hours of escalation, including coordinating with the losing carrier, resubmitting requests, or identifying alternative solutions.

Partial Port (Line-by-Line)

For business accounts or multi-line services, customers may request a partial port—transferring only specific lines while retaining others with the losing carrier.

Partial Port Guidelines:

- Each individual line requires its own TPIN and account verification
- The losing carrier must allow partial porting on the account; some carriers restrict this feature
- Corporate accounts may require additional authorization from the account administrator
- Partial ports follow the same timeline as standard ports on a per-line basis
- Remaining lines on the Aether Wireless account will be activated independently of the port status

Process for Partial Port:

1. Identify which specific line(s) the customer wishes to port.
 2. Collect separate TPINs and account information for each line being transferred.
 3. Submit separate port requests for each line in the Carrier Services Portal.
 4. Track each line's status independently and update the customer accordingly.
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FAQs

Q: What is a TPIN and where do I get it?

A: A TPIN (Transfer PIN) is a security code issued by your current carrier that authorizes the release of your phone number. You can obtain this PIN by logging into your account on the losing carrier's website, calling their customer service, or visiting a retail store. Some carriers use the terms "port PIN," "transfer code," or "account PIN" interchangeably.

Q: Can I port my number if I still owe money on my current phone?

A: Yes, you can typically port your number even with an outstanding device balance, but the balance remains owed to your previous carrier. Aether Wireless does not assume responsibility for unpaid device financing or early termination fees. You must pay any outstanding amounts to the losing carrier to avoid service

interruption or port rejection.

Q: How long does a same-region port take?

A: Same-region ports typically complete within 2-4 hours. However, ports submitted late in the day or during high-volume periods may carry over to the next business day. You should expect temporary service interruption of 15-30 minutes during the actual port transition.

Q: What happens if my port fails?

A: If your port fails, our team will contact you with the specific reason for failure. Common issues include incorrect TPIN, name/address mismatch, or account suspension with your previous carrier. We will guide you through resolving the issue and resubmitting the port request at no additional charge.

Q: Can I port a number from another country to Aether Wireless?

A: No. Aether Wireless only supports porting of US-based phone numbers at this time. International numbers cannot be ported to our network. If you are relocating to the US, you would need to obtain a new US phone number.

Q: What is the difference between same-region and cross-region porting?

A: Same-region porting occurs when the phone number is within the same Local Access and Transport Area (LATA) as our serving network. Cross-region porting involves numbers from a different LATA or geographic region, which requires additional coordination between carriers and therefore takes longer (24-48 hours versus 2-4 hours).

For additional assistance with number porting, contact the Port Desk at 1-800-555-PORT (24/7 escalation line) or email portdesk@aetherwireless.com.